

Saltwater Recreational Fishing Survey



Improve your fishing experiences!



Sponsored by NOAA Fisheries (National Marine Fisheries Service), Office of Science and Technology
<http://www.st.nmfs.noaa.gov/st5/index.html>

This survey is voluntary and all responses are confidential.

Questions? Contact Jorge Holzer at 301-405-1918 or email jholzer@umd.edu

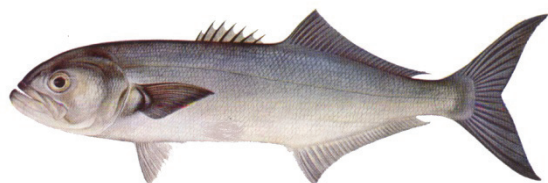
ATLANTIC SALTWATER FISH IN THIS SURVEY

Black Sea Bass



- Average catch is 1-3lbs., 12" to 20" total length
- Largest published recreational catch was 10lbs. 4oz.
- Minimum legal size varies by state, ranging from 10" to 13" total length
- Possession limit varies by state, ranging from 20 to 25 fish
- Popular bait include squid strips and small baitfish

Bluefish



- Average catch is 6-8lbs., 18" to 36" total length
- Largest published recreational catch was 31lbs. 12oz.
- Minimum legal size varies by state, ranging from no requirements to 12" total length
- Possession limit varies by state, ranging from 10 to 15 fish
- Popular bait include squid strips, silversides, and sand eels

Fluke/Summer Flounder



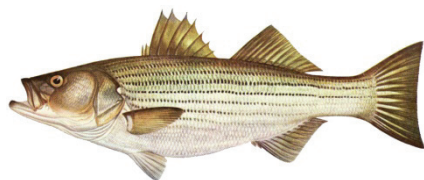
- Average catch is 2-5lbs., 14" to 20" total length
- Largest published recreational catch was 22lbs. 7oz.
- Minimum legal size varies by state, ranging from 14" to 21" total length
- Possession limit varies by state, ranging from 1 to 8 fish
- Popular bait include squid, small baitfish, and bluefish belly

Scup/Porgy



- Average catch is 1-2lbs., 10" to 14" total length
- Largest published recreational catch was 4lbs. 9oz.
- Minimum legal size varies by state, ranging from 8" to 11" total length
- Possession limit varies by state, ranging from 8 to 50 fish
- Popular bait include squid strips, small fish, sea worms, and clams

Striped Bass



- Average catch is 10-18lbs., 30" to 36" total length
- Largest published recreational catch was 125lbs.
- Minimum legal size varies by state, ranging from 18" to 32" total length
- Possession limit varies by state, ranging from 0 to 2 fish
- Popular bait include herring, menhaden, and mackerel

Weakfish



- Average catch is 1-6lbs., 14" to 22" total length
- Largest published recreational catch was 19lbs. 12oz.
- Minimum legal size varies by state, ranging from 12" to 16" total length
- Possession limit varies by state, ranging from 1 to 8 fish
- Popular bait include herring, menhaden, and mackerel

Section A: Your Saltwater Fishing Activities

The following questions help us understand the types of fishing trips anglers take.

1 How many **total** fishing trips for **saltwater** species did you make in 2018 during...

...the spring (March-May)?

...the fall (September-October)?

...the summer (June-August)?

...the winter (November-February)?

2 In period 2016-2018, how many trips did you go fishing for the following species? If you fished for more than one species on a single trip, please attribute the trip to the species that was most important to you.

Check this box if you go fishing sometimes without any particular species in mind: ☐

Bluefish

Scup (Porgy)

Black Sea Bass

Striped Bass

Fluke (Summer Flounder)

Weakfish

Other Flounders (not Fluke)

Other Fish

3 Of the trips you listed above for Black Sea Bass and Fluke, how many were...

...from shore?

...on a boat owned or rented by you or a friend?

...on a party boat or head boat (passenger fee covers a seat on the boat, usually 25 or more people fishing per boat)?

...on a private charter boat (charter fee pays for the entire boat and captain's services, usually 1-10 people per boat)?

4 Rate your fishing preference for the following species from 1 (least preferred) to 6 (most preferred):

Bluefish

Scup (Porgy)

Black Sea Bass

Striped Bass

Fluke (Summer Flounder)

Weakfish

Other Flounders (not Fluke)

Other Fish

5 Rate the impact of these factors on your decision to go fishing from 1 (no impact) to 6 (high impact):

Size Limits (the smallest sized fish you can legally keep)

Bag Limits (how many fish you can legally keep per day)

Number of fish you expect to catch

Number of fish you expect to keep

Number of fish you have to throw back until you get a keeper

Timing of the open fishing season

Trip Length

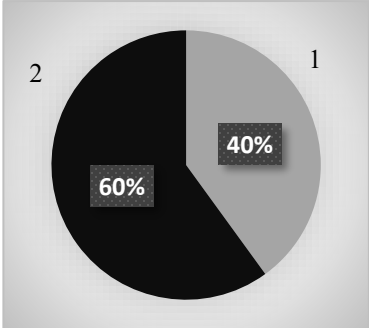
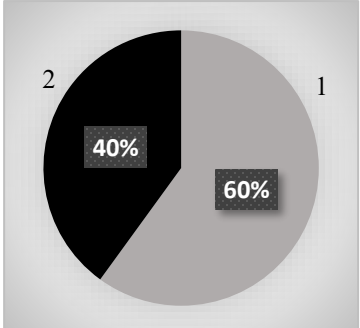
Trip Cost

Weather

SECTION B: SALTWATER FISHING TRIPS

Suppose that you have the choice between two recreational saltwater fishing trips (**Option 1** or **Option 2**) and not going recreational saltwater fishing (**Option 3**). Below the table, indicate which of these three options would be your first choice.

REGULATIONS
You are legally allowed to keep: 3 Fluke (Summer Flounder), 18” or longer 15 Black Sea Bass, 13” or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
CATCH	NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	4 Fluke	3 Fluke	Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> . Some fish are released if you catch more than the daily bag limit.	40% chance of 1 Fluke 60% chance of 2 Fluke No chance of more than 2 Fluke 	60% chance of 1 Fluke 40% chance of 2 Fluke No chance of more than 2 Fluke 	
	NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.	2 Black Sea Bass	2 Black Sea Bass	
	NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can</u> be <u>legally kept</u> .	1 Black Sea Bass	1 Black Sea Bass	
TRIP DETAILS	TRIP MODE	Small Private Boat (No fish finder available)	Shore Fishing	
	TRIP LENGTH Time spent fishing on this trip.	4 Hours	4 Hours	
	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	\$200	\$115	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Option 1
☐

Option 2
☐

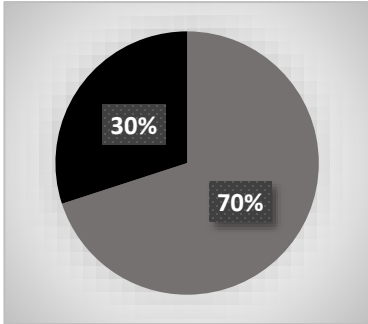
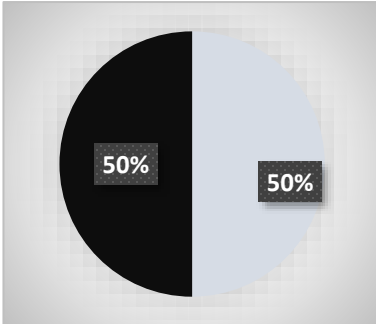
Option 3
☐

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3 Fluke (Summer Flounder), 18” or longer
15 Black Sea Bass, 13” or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
CATCH	NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	4 Fluke	3 Fluke	Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> . Some fish are released if you catch more than the daily bag limit.	70% chance of 1 Fluke 30% chance of 2 Fluke No chance of more than 2 Fluke 	50% chance of 0 Fluke 50% chance of 2 Fluke No chance of more than 2 Fluke 	
	NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.	2 Black Sea Bass	2 Black Sea Bass	
	NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can be legally kept</u> .	1 Black Sea Bass	1 Black Sea Bass	
TRIP DETAILS	TRIP MODE	Small Private Boat (Fish finder available)	Shore Fishing	
	TRIP LENGTH Time spent fishing on this trip.	4 Hours	3 Hours	
	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	\$150	\$115	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Option 1

☐

Option 2

☐

Option 3

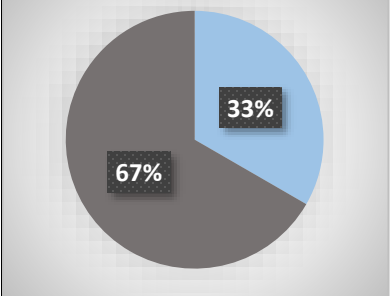
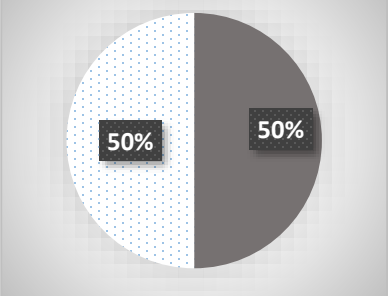
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15 Black Sea Bass, 13" or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
CATCH	NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	3 Fluke	3 Fluke	Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> . Some fish are released if you catch more than the daily bag limit.	33% chance of 0 Fluke 67% chance of 3 Fluke No chance of more than 3 Fluke 	50% chance of 1 Fluke 50% chance of 3 Fluke No chance of more than 3 Fluke 	
TRIP DETAILS	NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.	3 Black Sea Bass	3 Black Sea Bass	
	NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can be legally kept</u> .	1 Black Sea Bass	0 Black Sea Bass	
	TRIP MODE TRIP LENGTH Time spent fishing on this trip.	Private Boat (Fish finder available)	Shore Fishing	
	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	6 Hours	4.5 Hours	
		\$300	\$275	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Option 1



Option 2



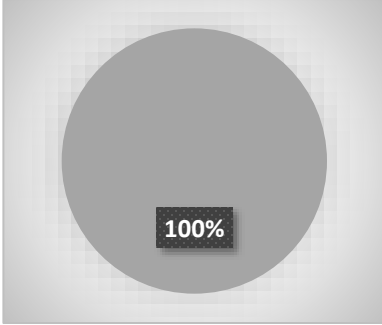
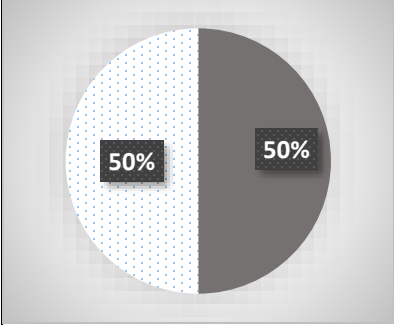
Option 3



SECTION B: SALTWATER FISHING TRIPS

Suppose that you have the choice between two recreational saltwater fishing trips (**Option 1** or **Option 2**) and not going recreational saltwater fishing (**Option 3**). Below the table, indicate which of these three options would be your first choice.

REGULATIONS
You are legally allowed to keep: 3 Fluke (Summer Flounder), 18" or longer 15 Black Sea Bass, 13" or longer

TRIP FEATURES		Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
CATCH	NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	3 Fluke	3 Fluke	Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> . Some fish are released if you catch more than the daily bag limit.	100% chance of 2 Fluke No chance of more than 2 Fluke 	50% chance of 1 Fluke 50% chance of 3 Fluke No chance of more than 3 Fluke 	
	NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.	2 Black Sea Bass	2 Black Sea Bass	
	NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can be legally kept</u> .	1 Black Sea Bass	1 Black Sea Bass	
TRIP DETAILS	TRIP MODE	Private Boat (Fish finder available)	Private Boat (No fish finder available)	
	TRIP LENGTH Time fishing on this trip.	6 Hours	6 Hours	
	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	\$300	\$275	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Option 1
☐

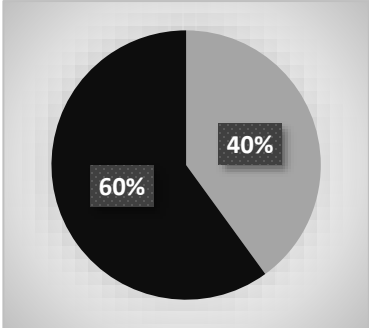
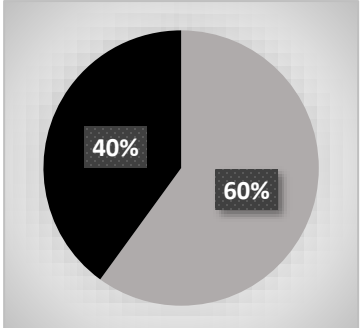
Option 2
☐

Option 3
☐

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TRIP FEATURES		Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
CATCH	NUMBER OF FISH YOU CATCH This number includes both undersized and legal size fish.	4 Fluke	3 Fluke	Do something other than saltwater fishing.
	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> . Some fish are released if you catch more than the daily bag limit.	40% chance of 1 Fluke 60% chance of 2 or 3 Fluke No chance of more than 3 Fluke 	60% chance of 1 Fluke 40% chance of 2 Fluke No chance of more than 2 Fluke 	
	NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.	2 Black Sea Bass	2 Black Sea Bass	
	NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can</u> be <u>legally kept</u> .	1 Black Sea Bass	1 Black Sea Bass	
TRIP DETAILS	TRIP MODE	Small Private Boat (No fish finder available)	Shore Fishing	
	TRIP LENGTH Time spent fishing on this trip.	4 Hours	3 Hours	
	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	\$200	\$115	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Option 1
☐

Option 2
☐

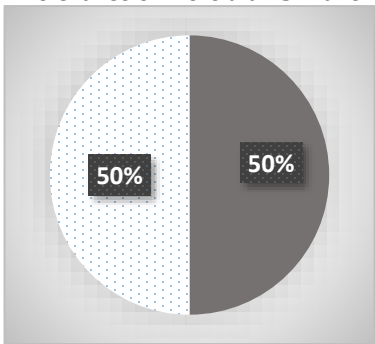
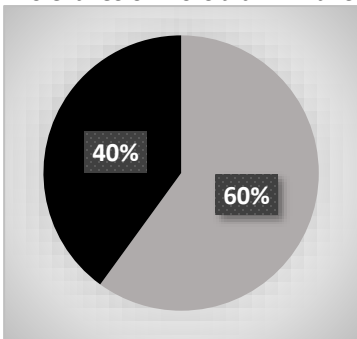
Option 3
☐

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TRIP FEATURES		Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
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	NUMBER OF LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP These fish are <u>at least legal minimum size</u> . Some fish are released if you catch more than the daily bag limit.	50% chance of 0 or 1 Fluke 50% chance of 2 or 3 Fluke No chance of more than 3 Fluke 	60% chance of 1 Fluke 40% chance of 2 Fluke No chance of more than 2 Fluke 	
TRIP DETAILS	NUMBER OF OTHER FISH YOU CATCH Other fish you catch.	2 Black Sea Bass	2 Black Sea Bass	
	NUMBER OF OTHER LEGAL-SIZE FISH YOU CAN KEEP Other fish you catch on this trip that <u>can</u> be <u>legally kept</u> .	1 Black Sea Bass	1 Black Sea Bass	
	TRIP MODE	Small Private Boat (No fish finder available)	Shore Fishing	
	TRIP LENGTH Time spent fishing on this trip.	4 Hours	4 Hours	
	TOTAL TRIP COST Your share of the fishing-related, transportation, and other expenses. This cost would not cover anyone else on the trip.	\$145	\$115	

If you were presented with these three options, which one would you choose? →
(Choose only one option.)

Option 1



Option 2



Option 3



SECTION C: ABOUT YOU AND YOUR HOUSEHOLD

The questions on this page are only to ensure that we have a representative sample of the angling population and will not be used to identify any specific individuals. Your answers are completely confidential.

1 Are you male or female? ☐ Male ☐ Female

2 What is your year of birth?

3 What is the highest level of education you have completed? (Please mark only **one** category)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Less than 9 th Grade | ☐ Bachelor's Degree (ex: BA or BS) |
| ☐ 9 th to 12 th Grade | ☐ Some graduate school |
| ☐ High school graduate or GED | ☐ Master's Degree (ex: MA, MS, MEng, MEd, MSW, MBA) |
| ☐ Some college, no degree | ☐ Professional Degree (ex: MD, DDS, DVM, LLB, JD) |
| ☐ Associate Degree (ex: AA or AS) | ☐ Doctorate Degree (ex: PhD, EdD) |

4 Are you of Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin?

- ☐ **No**, not of Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish Origin
- ☐ Yes, Mexican, Mexican American, Chicano
- ☐ Yes, Puerto Rican
- ☐ Yes, Cuban
- ☐ Yes, another Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish Origin: _____

5 What is your race? (Check **all** that apply)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ White | ☐ Korean |
| ☐ Black, African Am., or Negro | ☐ Vietnamese |
| ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native | ☐ Native Hawaiian |
| ☐ Asian Indian | ☐ Guamanian or Chamorro |
| ☐ Chinese | ☐ Samoan |
| ☐ Filipino | ☐ Other Asian or Pacific Islander: _____ |
| ☐ Japanese | ☐ Other: _____ |

6 Which of the following categories best describes your household's **total annual income before taxes** in 2018? (Please mark only **one** category)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Less than \$20,000 | ☐ \$80,000-\$99,999 |
| ☐ \$20,000-\$39,999 | ☐ \$100,000-\$149,999 |
| ☐ \$40,000-\$59,999 | ☐ \$150,000-\$199,999 |
| ☐ \$60,000-\$79,999 | ☐ \$200,000 or more |

7 Was this survey completed by the person to whom it was mailed? ☐ Yes ☐ No